



SELN Monthly Network Meeting

Key Takeaways

February 18, 2026

Overview

- This meeting featured a presentation and discussion of Employment First, a term used by states in the last 15 years to refer to an outcome, policy or initiative. The meeting also featured a new Data Note, study announcement, Data Deep Dives, upcoming sessions on the future of nonwork, and other reminders and project business.

Data Minute

- [Data Note 106](#) includes the findings from the National Survey of State Intellectual and Developmental Disabilities Agencies' (IDD) Day and Employment Services through FY 2023.
- This Data Note offers an overview of the data and highlights big-picture trends and main takeaways. This makes it ideal to use for communication with partners and programmatic decision-making.

Special Study on Career Advancement

- The Institute for Community Inclusion (ICI)'s Access to Integrated Employment (AIE) project team is launching recruitment for a national study of experiences of career advancement among people with IDD. Learn more [on the SELN Hub](#).

Data Deep Dives

- Meet with ICI staff to explore your state and national level data on employment services and outcomes for people with disabilities.
- Use this [form to submit a request](#)

The Next Chapter in Non-Work Working Group Series

- Sessions are held at 3PM ET on February 24, March 24 and April 28, 2026. [Learn more and register here.](#)

SELN E-Learning Course

- Winter Section ends Friday, February 13
- Spring Section enrollment opens Monday, February 23; course begins Monday, March 2

Upcoming Meetings

- March 18, 2026
- April 15, 2026 Spring Showcase

Hub Huddles

- Friday, February 20, 2026: The Hub Huddle will feature tips on navigating the Hub and ways to continue the conversation from the Monthly Network Meeting.
- Learn more and RSVP for the Hub Huddle [here.](#)

Discussion of Employment First: Where We Are and Where We're Going

- David Hoff presented an overview of the growth of Employment First as a national movement in the last few decades and current state-level Employment First efforts, noting that change will be driven by consistent implementation across states.
 - Check out the [APSE map of Employment First efforts](#)
 - Check out the [Employment First resource page](#) on the SELN Hub
- Wesley and Suzzanne led a discussion of the issues that members have navigated then and now as Employment First states, centering around the importance of connecting with how other audiences have come to understand this phrase as they implement it.

Materials

- [Slides](#)
- [Recording](#)